

The Encounter



An **encounter** is a word used to describe a meeting that is often unexpected, unusual, or brief.

Do we really turn into our parents?



A. Inherit	1. Exactly the same in every way; showing no differences.
B. Run in the family	2. Small, personal habits or ways of moving and speaking.
C. Features	3. To receive a physical or mental quality from your parents.
D. Mannerisms	4. To look or behave like an older relative in your family.
E. Identical	5. To look exactly like another person, like a twin or parent.
F. Take after	6. A quality or ability that many people in a family share.
G. Spitting image	7. A specific physical part of a person's face or body.

Read the statements. Do you think they are true or false?

1. The transition becomes noticeable around **age 50**.
2. We start mimicking our parents by using their **catchphrases**.
3. Most adults start buying the same brand of **alcohol** as their parents.
4. **Boredom** triggers your parents' exact facial expressions and sighs.
5. You find yourself enjoying the "**boring**" **hobbies** you once hated.
6. Couples **never** repeat the same arguments their parents had.
7. We unconsciously recreate the exact **home routines** of our **childhood**.
8. You start watching **TV news** as often as your parents used to.

The apple doesn't fall far from the tree

Chip off the old block

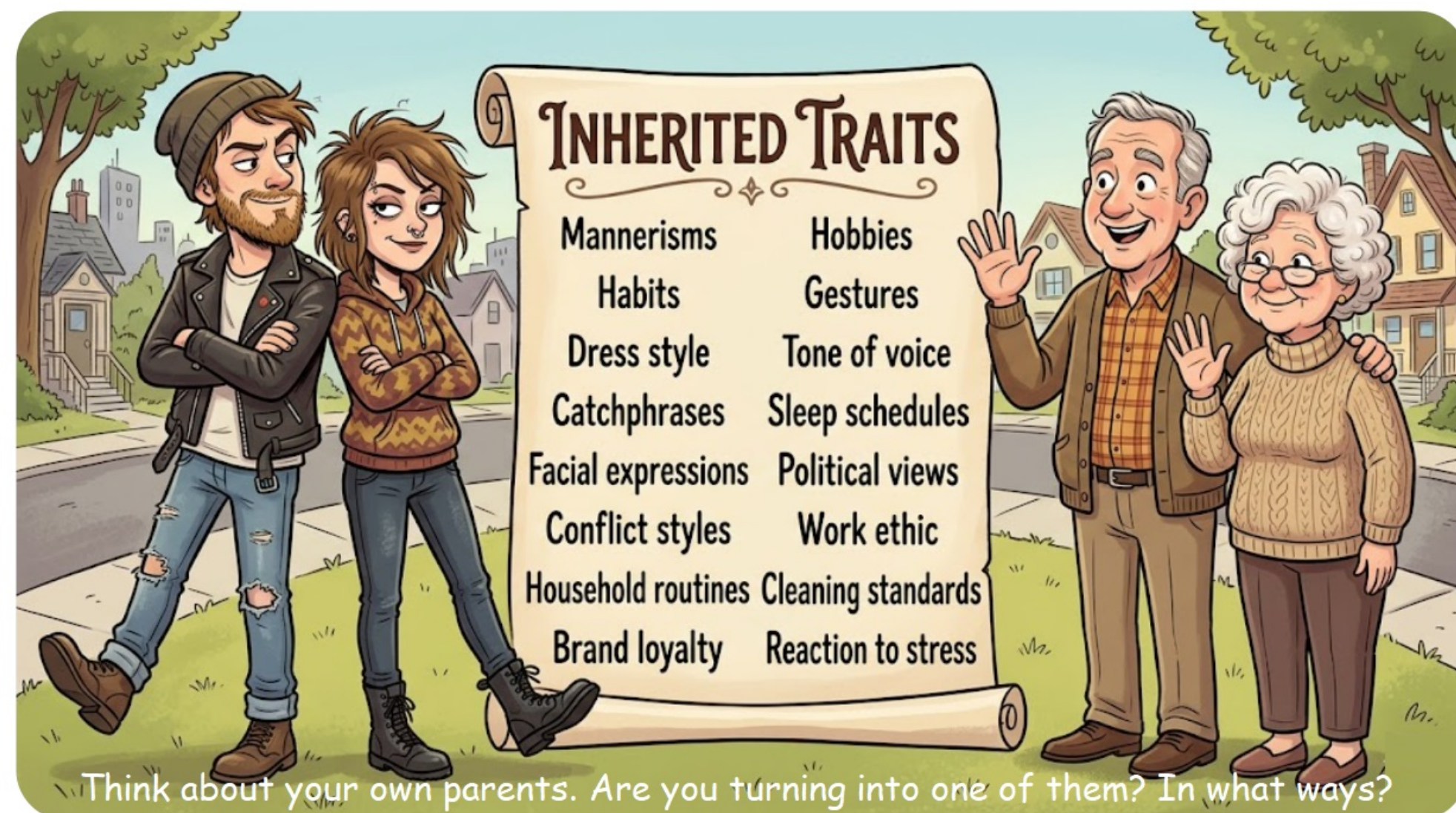
Cut from the same cloth

Follow in parent's footsteps

Like father, like son

What do these idioms and proverbs mean?
Do you agree with them?

Listen to four people. What **inherited traits** from the list on the right do they mention?



Think about your own parents. Are you turning into one of them? In what ways?



Alone
Again
Naturally

Nina Simone

I remember this afternoon
When my sister came into the room
She refused to say how my father was
But I knew he'd be dying soon

And I was oh so glad, and it was oh so sad
That I realized that I **despised** this man I once called Father
In his **hanging on**, with fingers **clutching**
His body now just eighty-eight pounds
Blinded eyes still searching
For some distant dream, that had **faded away** at the seams
Dying alone, naturally

I was his favourite child
I had him a little while
Just as long as I could play the piano and smile a little smile
Just when I needed him most
He was already a ghost
And for all my life there were promises
And they always have been broken

Leaving me alone with all my troubles
Not ever once touching me and saying
"Daughter, I'll help you **get over**"
Now he's fading away
And I'm glad to say
He's dying at last, naturally

It's a very sad thing to see that my mother with all her heart
Believes the words that the Bible said "**Til death do us two part**"
For her that was forever and ay
He **deceived** her night and day
How could some English words so small
Affect someone so strangely?

Taking her away from us, her soul included
She might as well be gone with him, all the children are excluded
Loneliness is hell, I know so well
For I'm alone, naturally

I waited for three weeks for him to die
I waited for three weeks for him to die
Every night he was calling on me
I wouldn't go to him
I waited for three weeks for him to die
Three weeks for him to die

And after he died, after he died
Every night I went out
Every night I had a fight
It didn't matter who it was with
'Cause I knew what it was about
And if you could read between lines
My Dad and I close as flies
I loved him then, and I loved him still
That's why my heart's so broken

Leaving me to doubt God in His mercy
And if He really does exist, then why did he desert me?
When he passed away
I smoked and drank all day
Alone again, naturally

- How did Nina feel about her dad when she was a child, on his deathbed, and when he passed away?
- How does Nina compare her own life struggles to the way her parents lived?
Does she see herself as being "cut from the same cloth" as them?
- We talked about inheriting features and mannerisms.
Can we also inherit "**loneliness**"?
- Nina says they were "**close as flies.**" Why is her heart "**broken**"?